Hanno Hilbig

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Employment

Assistant Professor, University of California, Davis, 2023 – Present

Department of Political Science

Affiliate Faculty, Designated Emphasis in Computational Social Science

Postdoctoral Fellow, Princeton University, 2022 – 2023

Center for the Study of Democratic Politics

Education

Ph.D., *Government*, Harvard University, 2022
M.S., *Economics*, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, 2016
B.A., *Economics* & *North American Studies*, Freie Universität Berlin, 2013

Publications

18. Biased Party Nominations as a Source of Women's Electoral Underperformance (with Pia Raffler and Thomas Fujiwara). Forthcoming, *American Journal of Political Science*.
17. How Budget Tradeoffs Undermine Electoral Incentives to Build Public Housing (with Andreas Wiedemann). 2026. *American Journal of Political Science*, 70(1): 202–220.
16. Does Rent Control Turn Tenants into NIMBYs? (with Anselm Hager and Robert Vief). 2026. *Journal of Politics*, online ahead of print.
15. The Green Transition and Political Polarization Along Occupational Lines (with Vincent Heddesheimer and Erik Voeten). 2026. *American Political Science Review*, 120(3): 853–875.
14. Do Autocrats Respond to Citizen Demands? Petitions and Housing Construction in the GDR (with Hans Lueders and Sascha Riaz). 2026. *Comparative Political Studies*, 59(4): 703–738.
13. Estimating Controlled Direct Effects with Panel Data: An Application to Reducing Support for Discriminatory Policies (with Matthew Blackwell, Adam Glynn, and Connor Phillips). 2026. *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series A*, 189(2): 1070–1089.
12. GERDA: The German Election Database (with Vincent Heddesheimer, Florian Sichart, and Andreas Wiedemann). 2025. *Scientific Data*, 12: 618.
11. The Gendered Persistence of Authoritarian Indoctrination (with Nourhan A. Elsayed, Sascha Riaz, and Daniel Ziblatt). 2025. *British Journal of Political Science*, 55: e124.
10. Natural Disasters and Green Party Support (with Sascha Riaz). 2024. *Journal of Politics*, 86(1): 241–256.
9. Government Spending and Voting Behavior (with Anselm Hager). 2024. *World Politics*, 76(1): 88–124.
8. Wealth of Tongues: Why Peripheral Regions Vote for the Radical Right in Germany (with Daniel Bischof and Daniel Ziblatt). 2024. *American Political Science Review*, 118(3): 1480–1496.
7. Local Newspaper Decline and Political Polarization: Evidence from a Multi-Party Setting (with Fabio Ellger, Sascha Riaz, and Philipp Tillmann). 2024. *British Journal of Political Science*, 54(4): 1256–1275.
6. Refugee Labor Market Access Increases Support for Immigration (with Anselm Hager and Sascha Riaz). 2024. *Comparative Political Studies*, 57(5): 749–777.
5. Local News Monopolies Increase Misperceptions about Immigration (with Sascha Riaz). 2023. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, 49(17): 4536–4558.

4. Freedom of Movement Restrictions Inhibit the Psychological Integration of Refugees (with Sascha Riaz). 2022. *Journal of Politics*, 84(4): 2288–2293.
3. Locked Out of College: When Admissions Bureaucrats Do and Do Not Discriminate (with Jacob Brown). 2022. *British Journal of Political Science*, 52(3): 1436–1446.
2. Does Public Opinion Affect Political Speech? (with Anselm Hager). 2020. *American Journal of Political Science*, 64(4): 921–937.
1. Do Inheritance Customs Affect Political and Social Inequality? (with Anselm Hager). 2019. *American Journal of Political Science*, 63(4): 758–773.

Working Papers

1. Voter Responses to Climate Adaptation in High-Risk Communities (with Christian Baehr and António Valentim). R&R, *American Journal of Political Science*.
2. Long-run Political Change after the Great Recession (with Vincent Heddesheimer). R&R, *American Political Science Review*.
3. Bureaucratic Inertia or Legal Responsiveness? College Admissions Officers' Behavior Before and After the Affirmative Action Ban (with Jacob Brown and Hunter Rendleman). R&R, *Perspectives on Politics*.
4. Place-Based Policies, Local Responses, and Electoral Behavior (with Vincent Heddesheimer and Andreas Wiedemann).
5. Foreign Policy Debates Shape Refugees' Psychological Integration (with Florian Sichart and Georgiy Syunyaev).
6. Salient Shock, Imperceptible Impacts: Germans' Immigration Attitudes and the 2022–2023 Energy Price Spike (with Niloufar Davis, W. M. Halm, and Daniel J. Hopkins).
7. Open-Weight LLMs Are Often Competitive with Commercial APIs for Political Science Text Classification.
8. Reindustrialization and Political Change (with Vincent Heddesheimer and Marc Sabatier Hvidkjær). (draft available upon request)
9. Electoral Responses to Local Cooperations with Radical-Right Parties (with Philipp Heyna, Violeta I. Haas, and Tim Wappenhans). (draft available upon request)

Public Engagement and Policy Reports

1. Why Do Mainstream Parties Lose Either Way on Accommodating the Far Right? 2026. Guest essay, *Popular by Design*.
2. Can Regional Policy Stabilize Structural Transformation? Evidence on the Political Effects of Regional Development Policy in Germany (with V. Heddesheimer, D. Posch, and J. Südekum). 2026. Bertelsmann Foundation. German-language version.
3. Targeted Infrastructure Spending Slows AfD Gains in Germany's Industrial Heartlands (with Vincent Heddesheimer, Daniel Posch, and Jens Südekum). 2026. Coauthored article, *Social Europe*.
4. Navigating California's Wildfire Insurance Challenge: Community Demographics and the FAIR Plan (with L. Hen and M. Macaraeg). 2025. California Policy Lab, University of California.

Grants and Fellowships

Society of Hellman Fellows Award, UC Davis, $33,000, 2025–2026.

Hoover Institution RAI Grant, Stanford University, $25,000, 2025 (with Vincent Heddesheimer, Steven Han, and Jake Jares).

Research Grant, Multidisciplinary Program in Inequality & Social Policy, $5,000, 2022.

Graduate School of Arts and Sciences Emergency Grants, $7,000 each, 2020 & 2021.

Krupp Foundation Dissertation Research Fellowship & Emergency Grant, $16,300 each, 2019 & 2021.

Research Stipend, Multidisciplinary Program in Inequality & Social Policy, $12,000, 2018.

Invited Talks

2027 (scheduled): University College London; London School of Economics; University of Gothenburg; University of Oxford; University of Utah

2026: Duke University; University of Notre Dame; Vanderbilt University; University of Mannheim / MZES; Research Workshop in American Politics (RWAP), UC Berkeley; BESI Climate Seminar, Berkeley Economy & Society Initiative

2025: University of Southern California, University of Wisconsin-Madison

2024: University of California, Berkeley, University of Texas at Austin

Before 2024: University of California, Davis (2023); LMU Munich (2022); Humboldt University Berlin (2020 & 2022)

Conference Presentations

2026: APSA, European Political Science Society (EPSS)

2025: APSA, MPSA, EPSA, Toronto Political Behavior Workshop (University of Toronto), Representation in Divided Democracies Workshop (ETH Zurich), Money in Politics Conference (Copenhagen Business School)

2024: APSA, EPSA, Political Economy of Europe APSA Pre-Conference, Copenhagen Housing Policy Workshop, Toronto Political Behavior Workshop (Montréal)

2023: APSA, MPSA, EPSA, NEWEPS, UC Berkeley Housing Conference

Before 2023: APSA, MPSA, EPSA, NEWEPS, EuroWEPS, Asian PolMeth, Barcelona Politics & History Conference, Nuffield Junior Workshop

Teaching Experience

Courses taught: Quantitative Research Methods; Empirical Methods in Political Science; Modeling Politics: Game Theory and Political Economy; Political Economy; Urban Public Policy; Advanced Quantitative Methods & Data Science.

Software & Data

U.S. House (2018–2024) and Senate (2002–2024) Candidate Websites. Version 2.0. Harvard Dataverse, 2026.

CLARA: Communication of Local German Party Associations, Recorded Annually (2015–2026). Chapter-year panel of 2,635 local German party organizations and 278,638 archived news articles.

Political Science LLM Benchmark. 2026. Matched evaluation of 31 open-weight and commercial language models on 33 political science text-coding tasks, with cost and generation speed.

GERDA dataset and data portal, *Scientific Data* 12:618 (2025). DOI: 10.1038/s41597-025-04811-5.
R package (CRAN), Maintainer. DOI: 10.32614/CRAN.package.gerda.
Python package (PyPI), Author and Maintainer, 2026.

German broadband coverage data, municipality-level panel of broadband coverage from 2005–2021 standardized to 2021 municipal boundaries.

Professional Service

Co-organizer, Junior Scholars Workshop, Transformations of Democracy Unit, WZB Berlin, 2023–Present

Co-organizer, Bay Area Workshop in Empirical Comparative Politics (EUREKA), 2025–Present

Referee: *American Political Science Review, American Journal of Political Science, Journal of Politics, British Journal of Political Science, Political Behavior, Quarterly Journal of Economics, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Comparative Political Studies*